

NETWORKING FUNDAMENTALS III





COURSE STRUCTURE

Day 1: Networking Fundamentals I

Day 2: Networking Fundamentals II

Day 3: Networking Fundamentals II

Day 4: Network Security in Depth

Day 5: Routing Fundamentals & Capstone

AGENDA FOR DAY 3

1. Systematic Troubleshooting Methodology
2. OSI-Based Troubleshooting
3. Essential Diagnostic Tools: ping, traceroute, Wireshark
4. Cisco IOS Verification Commands
5. Course Review & Knowledge Check
6. Bridge to Routing & Switching Essentials



TROUBLESHOOTING METHODOLOGY

THE STRUCTURED TROUBLESHOOTING APPROACH

Step 1 — Define the problem: exactly what is broken? What was the last change made?

Step 2 — Gather information: ping tests, show commands, interface counters, logs, topology

Step 3 — Analyze: identify the likely layer and form a hypothesis

Step 4 — Test: make ONE change at a time, then retest — never change multiple things simultaneously

Step 5 — Eliminate: if the change didn't fix it, revert and try the next hypothesis

Step 6 — Document: record root cause and fix — builds the team's knowledge base

Top-down (L7→L1) vs Bottom-up (L1→L7): choose based on symptoms — no link light = start at L1

OSI-BASED TROUBLESHOOTING

- Layer 1 (Physical): check link lights, cable type, damaged cable, correct SFP/transceiver, speed/duplex
- Layer 2 (Data Link): verify MAC table, VLAN assignment, trunk config, STP port state, CRC/FCS errors
- Layer 3 (Network): verify IP addressing, subnet mask, default gateway, routing table, ACLs applied
- Layer 4 (Transport): confirm correct port is open, firewall rules, NAT translation table
- Layer 5–7 (Application): test with curl/browser, DNS resolution, TLS certificate validity, app logs
- Strategy: no connectivity at all → start at L1; partial connectivity → start at L3–4

POP QUIZ:

A user can ping their default gateway but not reach any external websites. What should you check first?

- A. The user's NIC driver
- B. DNS resolution and routing beyond the gateway
- C. The user's operating system
- D. Switch port VLAN assignment



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- B. **DNS resolution and routing beyond the gateway**
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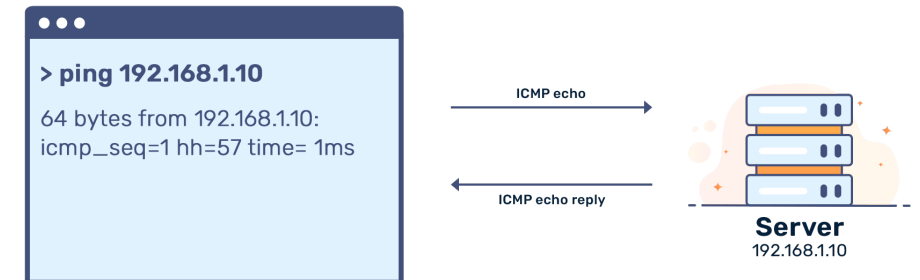


ESSENTIAL DIAGNOSTIC TOOLS

PING — TESTING REACHABILITY LAYER BY LAYER

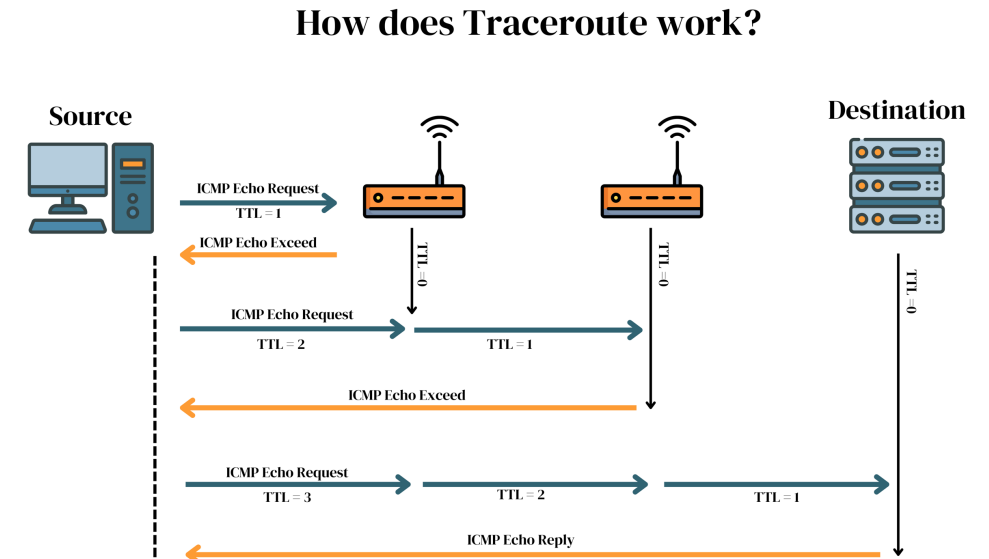
- ping 127.0.0.1 — tests TCP/IP stack on local machine (loopback)
- ping <default-gateway> — confirms Layer 3 connectivity to the router
- ping <remote-host> — tests end-to-end path through the network
- Extended ping (Cisco IOS): specify source interface, count, size, timeout
- Interpret: ! = reply | . = timeout | U = unreachable | M = MTU issue
- If gateway ping fails: L1/L2 issue (cable, VLAN, ARP) — check before assuming L3
- If gateway succeeds but remote fails: routing or ACL issue beyond the gateway

Ping Sequence



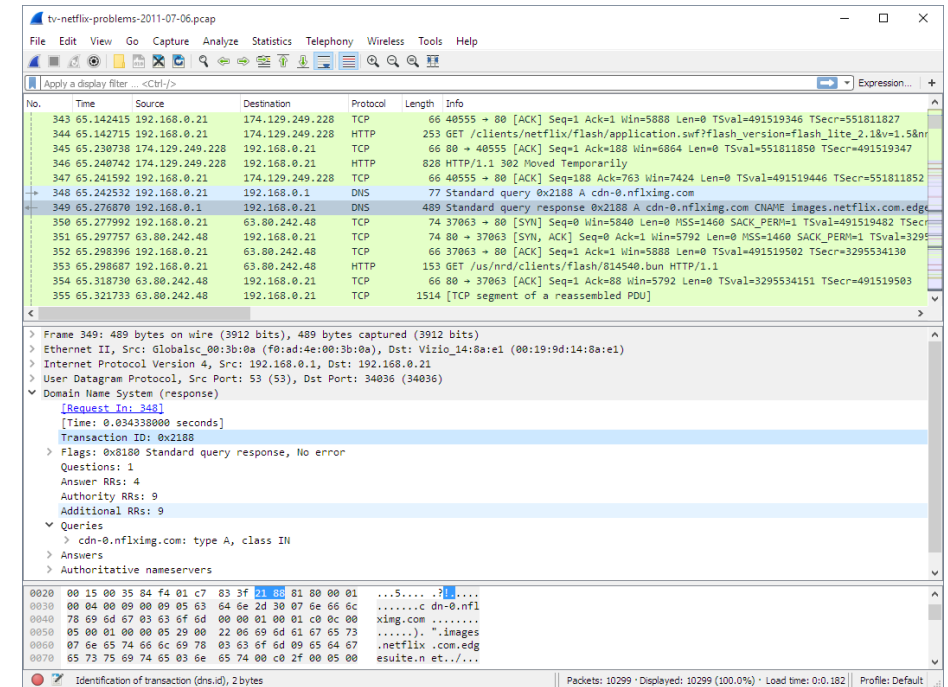
TRACEROUTE — MAPPING THE NETWORK PATH

- Sends packets with incrementing TTL; each router sends back 'Time Exceeded' revealing its IP
- Output: hop number | IP address | round-trip time (3 probes per hop)
- Asterisks (**): router exists but filters ICMP — not necessarily broken
- Identifies exactly WHERE packets are being dropped or excessively delayed
- Windows: tracert (uses ICMP) | Linux/Mac: traceroute (uses UDP by default)
- traceroute -I on Linux forces ICMP — better behavior against Cisco devices
- Useful for: routing loops, suboptimal paths, ISP handoff point verification



WIRESHARK — PACKET CAPTURE & ANALYSIS

- Captures and displays every packet on a network interface in real time
- Color-coded by protocol; shows all layers: Ethernet, IP, TCP/UDP, DNS, HTTP, TLS
- Filter syntax: `ip.addr==192.168.1.1 | tcp.port==80 | dns | arp | icmp | http`
- Follow TCP Stream: right-click → Follow → TCP Stream — see full HTTP conversation
- ARP analysis: spot duplicate IPs, gratuitous ARPs, ARP poisoning attempts
- DNS: verify correct resolution, check response IPs and TTL values
- Best for: unexplained drops, application debugging, security incident analysis



CISCO IOS VERIFICATION COMMANDS

- show ip interface brief — all interfaces, IPs, status (up/up, admin down, down/down)
- show running-config | section interface — show all interface configs
- show ip route — routing table; C=connected S=static O=OSPF D=EIGRP
- show arp — ARP cache (IP ↔ MAC mappings on this device)
- show mac address-table — switch MAC table: which MAC is on which port/VLAN
- show vlan brief — VLAN database and port assignments
- show interfaces — full statistics: CRC errors, input/output drops, runs, giants
- Pipe modifiers: | include | section | begin — filter large outputs



ARP, ICMP & MTU IN PRACTICE

ARP (Address Resolution Protocol): resolves IP → MAC within local subnet

arp -a (Windows/Linux): shows local ARP cache — useful to verify L2 discovery

Gratuitous ARP: device announces its own MAC/IP — used by HSRP, causes cache refresh

ICMP TTL: each router decrements TTL by 1; at 0 → Time Exceeded sent back to sender

MTU (Maximum Transmission Unit): Ethernet = 1500 bytes; oversized packets fragmented or dropped

Path MTU Discovery: TCP uses 'don't fragment' bit; routers return 'Fragmentation Needed' if packet too large

Jumbo frames: MTU > 1500 (up to 9000) — used in data center storage traffic

POP QUIZ:

In a traceroute output, what do three asterisks (***) for a hop typically indicate?

- A. The hop does not exist
- B. ICMP is filtered or the router is not responding to probes
- C. The path has a routing loop
- D. The destination is unreachable



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DAY 1 RECAP: FOUNDATIONS & ADDRESSING

- Networks connect devices via endpoints, links, and intermediaries — scales from home to Internet
- OSI 7-layer model gives us a common language for design and troubleshooting
- TCP = reliable, ordered (SYN/SYN-ACK/ACK); UDP = fast, connectionless
- IPv4: 32-bit dotted decimal; RFC1918 private ranges; CIDR /N notation
- Subnetting: block size = $256 - \text{mask octet}$; VLSM assigns different sizes to match requirements
- IPv6: 128-bit hex notation; link-local (fe80::/10) auto-assigned; no broadcast

DAY 2 RECAP: SERVICES & SECURITY

- DNS: hierarchical name resolution — A, AAAA, CNAME, MX, PTR, TXT records; UDP/TCP 53
- DHCP DORA: Discover → Offer → Request → Acknowledge; relay agent crosses routers
- NAT/PAT: private IPs hidden behind one public IP using port numbers
- ACLs: standard (source IP only) applied near destination; extended applied near source
- Firewalls: stateless (packet filter) vs stateful (connection tracking) vs NGFW
- Wi-Fi: WPA3 > WPA2 > WPA (avoid) > WEP (never); enterprise uses 802.1X + RADIUS
- VPNs: IPsec (site-to-site) and SSL/TLS (remote access) encrypt over untrusted networks

POP QUIZ:

Which command quickly shows all interfaces, their IP addresses, and status on a Cisco device?

- A. show running-config
- B. show ip route
- C. show ip interface brief
- D. show arp



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POP QUIZ:

Which OSI layer does a switch primarily operate at?

- A. Layer 1 – Physical
- B. Layer 2 – Data Link
- C. Layer 3 – Network
- D. Layer 4 – Transport



WHAT YOU'VE BUILT — AND WHAT'S NEXT

- You now understand how data moves across any network — from bits on a wire to application data
- These fundamentals are the foundation every network engineer builds on every day
- Routing & Switching Essentials takes every topic deeper into enterprise-grade configuration
- In R&S you will configure: VLANs, trunks, STP, OSPF, EIGRP, HSRP, EtherChannel, data center design
- The Cisco IOS commands you learned here become your daily toolkit in R&S labs
- Cloud networking courses map these exact concepts to AWS/Azure (VPC=subnet, SG=firewall, Route Table=routing)

LAB 07: NETWORK DIAGNOSTICS & VERIFICATION

- Goal: Build a multi-subnet network and verify every layer using Cisco IOS diagnostic tools
 - Build: 1 router, 2 switches, 4 PCs, 1 server — two LAN subnets (192.168.10.0/24 and 192.168.20.0/24)
 - Configure: Static IPs on all devices; both router interfaces up with correct addressing
 - Ping layer by layer: loopback → gateway → same subnet → remote subnet
 - Traceroute: Map the path LAN1 → LAN2; interpret hops, RTT, and ***
 - Inspect Layer 2: show arp and show mac address-table — verify IP-to-MAC resolution
 - Verify: show ip interface brief and show ip route — confirm interfaces and routing table
 - Error counters: show interfaces — identify CRC errors, runts, and drops
 - Filter outputs: Practice | include, | section, | begin
 - Document: OSI layer summary table — tool, command, and finding at each layer

LAB 08: BUILD & VERIFY A COMPLETE SMALL NETWORK

- Goal: Apply all 3 days of learning to design and implement a working office network
- Steps:
 - Design: 192.168.0.0/24 split into 3 subnets: 60 hosts, 25 hosts, WAN /30
 - Build in Packet Tracer: 1 router, 2 switches, PCs, 1 server (DNS+DHCP)
 - Configure DHCP scopes for both LAN subnets; DNS server with A records
 - Configure PAT for Internet access; static NAT for the server (inbound access)
 - Apply ACL: deny Telnet from LAN2 to LAN1; permit everything else
 - Verify: all PCs get IPs, resolve DNS names, ACL enforced, router has correct routing table
 - Document: IP plan table, network diagram, list of CLI commands used